

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5 ♣

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

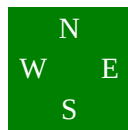
♠ Q 10 4
♥ J 9 8
♦ Q J 4
♣ J 10 7 2

♠ K 7 5 2

♥ 6 4

♦ A 8 3

♣ A K 6 4



♠ A 9 8 3

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 3

♠ J 6

♥ Q 10 5 3

♦ K 10 7 2

♣ Q 9 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Partner accepts the invitation.

South would play 4 ♠.

Click

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 2. West plays ♦ J.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 2. West plays ♦ J.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 5

Counting losers from the North hand you have 2 ♣ losers to get rid of. If you had counted from the South hand there would have been 2 ♥ losers to get rid of. In any case the plan is the same.

Win the ♦ A and play ♠ A and ♠ K. If the ♠s split 3-2 you are home-free. Leave the master trump out and play your ♣ A K and dummy's ♥ A K. Then cross-ruff ♣s and ♥s. Whichever defender holds the last trump is welcome to ruff with it at any time. The defense is also welcome to take their 2 ♦s at any time. Your 10 tricks are safe.

This is another example of the general principle to leave a master trump out.

South and North were able to make all their small trumps individually.

If West ruffs the fourth ♥ with his master ♠ Q North just discards a ♦ loser and makes an overtrick.

There is an excellent bidding guideline which tells you how to respond with two 4-card Majors. You bid them "up-the-line". That means you bid 1 ♥.

Partner's rebid is 1 ♠.

This hand shows why responder should bid "up-the-line". Partner can now show a 4-card ♠ suit at the 1-level. Imagine the suits reversed - you first respond with 1 ♠. If partner wanted to show a ♥ suit he would have to go to the 2-level, and he might not have the strength to do so.

Back to the actual situation. Over partner's 1 ♠ bid you jump to 3 ♠. This jump shows about 11-12 points and good ♠ support (4 cards). In case you thought this showed 13 or more points that wouldn't be logical. If you had 13 points and 4 ♠s you would jump all the way to game. So 3 ♠ is invitational.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ 6 5 3
 ♦ J 4
 ♣ A K 9 6 5 2

♠ Q 10 7

♥ 9 8 4

♦ K 10 5 2

♣ J 10 3



♠ A 9 8 3

♥ A K 7

♦ A 9 8 6

♣ 7 4

♠ K 6 5 2

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ Q 7 3

♣ Q 8

West	North	East	South
	Pass	1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

the ♣s split 3-2, which is very likely, you can set up the tricks you need. **BUT**, if you just play ♣A ♣K and then a small one you'll be sorry. Those extra three ♣s will be established as winners but you will have no entry to them.

Instead, you play your ♣4 to the second trick and also play a low card from dummy. This is called Ducking the trick. North/South will certainly win that trick, but you are in control. You can win whatever suit they play and you still have that ♣7 to reach dummy's solid ♣s.

You can see that with ♣s splitting 3-2 the Duck insures the contract.

But just imagine you had played ♣A, ♣K, ♣2. At that point ♣ 9 6 5 would all be winners, but don't think North is going to let you reach dummy with either of those two Jacks!

You have 15 points and you have a balanced distribution. You should open 1NT. It is true that you do not have ♣s stopped, but you are not required to have a stopper in all the suits to open 1NT. Partner jumps to 3NT and you pass.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥Q.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥Q.

Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 6

In many Notrump hands it is good to hold up to disrupt the defender's communications. In this hand you have a double-stopper in ♥s but only a single stop in ♠s and ♦s so win the first trick.

You need 3 more tricks from the ♣ suit. As long as the ♣s split 3-2, which is very likely, you can set up the tricks you need. **BUT**, if you just play ♣A ♣K and then a small one you'll be sorry. Those extra three ♣s will be established as winners but you will have no entry to them.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 10 5
 ♥ J 7 6 2
 ♦ Q J 10 7
 ♣ 5

♠ K 7 4

♥ K 5

♦ A 6 4

♣ Q 8 7 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 6 3 2

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ 9 8 3

♣ A

♠ 9

♥ A 9 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K J 10 9 6 2

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♣
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	5 ♣
All Pass			

5 ♣ by South

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

Is there any doubt? Although you only have 11 HCP your 6-card suit adds 2 more. And with 13 points you should always open. So you open 1 ♣.

Partner responds 3 ♣.

With the ♣ fit your hand is now revalued to 15 points. But it's still a close thing. You may be able to make 5 ♣ or you may not.

Passing would not be horrible - but when in doubt it is usually better to be bold. You cross your fingers and bid 5 ♣.

South plays 5 ♣. West leads the ♦ Q.

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The two black Aces aren't going away so if you are to make this contract you must do something about your ♦ loser. And the only likely place to put it is on dummy's ♠K. If West has the ♠A, you can lead up to the ♠K and make a winner out of it.

Suppose you win the ♦ Q in dummy and play a ♣. Somebody will win the ♣A and play another ♦. You win this and lead toward the ♠K. No good. West jumps up with his ♠A and sets you with a ♦ winner.

The problem was that when you played a trump you let the timing go to the defense. They could knock out your last ♦ stopper while they still had the ♠A. Try it this way.

Win the ♦ in your hand and immediately play the ♠9. If West doesn't take his ♠A he'll never get it, so assume he goes up. Now he leads ♦ J but you win, get to dummy with the ♥K and play the ♠K, discarding the ♦ loser.

Pulling trumps is very important, but sometimes there is something you must do **BEFORE** you play trumps.

In this hand that something is to establish the ♠K so you can discard your ♦ loser.